



MOBILIZING IN SEATTLE • SEPTEMBER 18-19, 2026

PARTICIPANT CHALLENGE BRIEF

Trust Your Synthetic Teammates

Sponsored by Naval Air Warfare Center Training Systems Division (NAWCTSD)

CHALLENGE SUMMARY

Create engaging gameplay for one or more players that reinforces effective teaming and trust-calibration strategies in a Human-Autonomy Interaction (HAI) context.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The proliferation of AI products, including in critical and high-risk decision domains, requires prudence in both application and operator training. Failure to trust critical system outputs, recommendations, or conclusions could be catastrophic in time-critical contexts.

THE CHALLENGE

Develop gameplay that helps players learn when to trust and when to distrust AI-enabled teammates. The experience should balance human trust with actual AI capability and reward effective trust calibration while mitigating complacency, misuse, disuse, mistrust, and distrust. The genre is open to the team's creativity. Functional AI agents are not required; non-player characters may simulate AI behavior.

BENEFICIARIES

Individuals and teams executing missions with increasingly complex AI capabilities across military command, space, health care, emergency response, commerce, and other decision-intensive domains.

EXAMPLE USE CASES

Training individuals to partner with AI-enabled agents; practicing judgment in high-risk decisions; recognizing over trust and under trust; strengthening human-autonomy cooperation.

DEFINITION OF A WINNING PROTOTYPE

Creativity of approach and engagement of gameplay.

HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS

No specific requirements or suggestions.

SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

No special requirements.

SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT SUPPORT

Subject Matter Experts from NAWCTSD's Science and Technology workforce.

HELPFUL LINKS AND RESOURCES

Suggested reading:

- Measurement of Trust in Automation: A Narrative Review and Reference Guide, Spencer C. Kohn et al. (2021)
- Exploring Human-Robot Trust Through the Investment Game, Emy Arts et al. (2020)
- Effects of Explainable Artificial Intelligence on Trust and Human Behavior in a High-Risk Decision Task, Benedikt Leichtmann et al. (2023)
- What Is It Like to Trust a Rock? A Functionalist Perspective on Trust and Trustworthiness in Artificial Intelligence, Peter R. Lewis et al. (2022)
- The Impact of Training on Human-Autonomy Team Communications and Trust Calibration, Craig Johnson et al. (2021)